

SILVERLEAF ACADEMY

Google Calendar & Shared Calendars

Staff Guide — How to Set Up, Share and Use Calendars Across the School

Systems & Automation Programme (SLAAA) | 2026

About This Guide

This guide explains how Silverleaf Academy uses Google Calendar to manage school-wide events, department schedules, and shared resources across all campuses. It covers how to create and share calendars, how to subscribe to shared calendars, and the naming conventions and permissions the whole team follows.

Who this guide is for: All SLA staff — department leaders, admin team, teachers and campus leads.

1. Why We Use Shared Calendars

Google Calendar is Silverleaf's central scheduling tool. Shared calendars allow the whole team to see what is happening across the school without needing to ask — reducing missed meetings, scheduling conflicts and manual coordination. Every department and campus has its own calendar that feeds into a school-wide view.

- **Everyone can see the right information at the right time**
- Department leaders can plan without conflicts across teams
- Parents and guardians can be invited to relevant events
- All campuses stay aligned on key dates and deadlines
- Events link directly to Google Meet for remote sessions

2. SLA Calendar Structure

Silverleaf uses a layered calendar system. Each layer has a specific purpose and audience. Staff subscribe to the calendars relevant to their role.

Calendar Name	Owner / Manager	Who Can See	Purpose
SLA — School Wide	School Leadership / HT	All Staff	Term dates, public holidays, school-wide events and key deadlines
SLA — Academic	Julius / Academics	All Staff	Timetable changes, exams, report deadlines, PD days
SLA — Finance	Lilian / Finance	Finance + SLT	Fee deadlines, payroll dates, budget submission dates

SLA — HR & People	Esther / HR	All Staff	Recruitment deadlines, staff events, leave planning windows
SLA — Operations	Baraka / Ops	Ops + Campus Leads	Transport changes, facilities bookings, maintenance windows
SLA — Marketing	Marketing Lead	Marketing + SLT	Campaign dates, tours, events, enrollment windows
SLA — Student Experience	Student Exp. Lead	All Staff	Co-curricular schedule, boarding events, student activities
SLA — Data & Tech	Paul / Tech	Tech Team + SLT	System maintenance, EdAdmin updates, training sessions
SLA — Eduki & Partnerships	Paul	SLT + Project Team	Partnership meetings, Eduki visit, advisory sessions

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All calendar names follow the format: SLA — [Department]. This keeps every calendar easily identifiable when multiple calendars appear in a single view.

3. Setting Up Your Google Calendar

3.1 Creating a New Shared Calendar

Follow these steps to create a new department or school-wide calendar:

#	Action	Details
1	Open Google Calendar	Go to calendar.google.com and sign in with your Silverleaf Google Workspace account (@silverleafacademy.com).
2	Create calendar	On the left sidebar, click the '+' icon next to 'Other calendars' and select 'Create new calendar'.
3	Name the calendar	Use the SLA naming convention: SLA — [Department]. Example: SLA — Finance or SLA — Operations.
4	Add a description	Write a short description of what the calendar is for (e.g. 'Finance team deadlines, payroll dates and budget milestones').
5	Set the time zone	Select East Africa Time (EAT, UTC+3) to ensure all campuses stay aligned.
6	Click Create Calendar	The calendar will appear in your 'My Calendars' list on the left sidebar.

3.2 Sharing Your Calendar with the Team

After creating a calendar, you need to share it so others can view or edit it.

#	Action	Details
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1	Open Calendar Settings	Click the three dots next to your calendar name in the left sidebar, then select 'Settings and sharing'.
2	Scroll to 'Share with specific people'	Click '+ Add people and groups'.
3	Enter email addresses	Add individual staff emails or a Google Group (e.g. all-staff@silverleafacademy.com) to share with multiple people at once.
4	Set permissions	Choose the right permission level — see Section 4 for guidance on which level to use.
5	Click Send	The invited person will receive an email with a link to add the calendar to their account.
6	Confirm sharing	The person's name or email will appear under 'Share with specific people' once added.

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Use Google Groups (e.g. all-staff@silverleafacademy.com) to share with many people at once. Ask Paul or Nehemia to set up a Google Group for your department if you do not have one yet.

3.3 Subscribing to a Shared Calendar

When someone shares a calendar with you, follow these steps to add it to your view:

1. Open the invitation email from Google Calendar and click 'Add this calendar'.
2. Alternatively, in Google Calendar, click '+' next to 'Other calendars' and select 'Subscribe to calendar'.
3. Enter the email address of the calendar owner or paste the shareable calendar link.
4. The calendar will appear in your 'Other calendars' list on the left sidebar.
5. Click the calendar name to toggle it on or off in your view.

3.4 Making a Calendar Public (for Parent-Facing Events)

Certain calendars — such as school events, sports fixtures or term dates — may be shared with parents or guardians. To make a calendar accessible outside of SLA:

6. Open Calendar Settings for the relevant calendar.
7. Under 'Access permissions for events', tick 'Make available to public'.
8. Set permission to 'See only free/busy (hide details)' for parent-facing calendars to protect staff privacy.
9. Copy the shareable link and send to parents via the parent portal or WhatsApp broadcast.

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Only the school-wide calendar (SLA — School Wide) and the Student Experience calendar should be shared publicly. All other calendars should remain internal.

4. Calendar Permission Levels

Google Calendar has four permission levels. Use the right level for each person or group to protect information while keeping the team informed.

Permission Level	What They Can Do	When to Use It
See only free/busy	See that time is blocked but not what the event is	Parent-facing and external calendars
See all event details	View full event title, description, location and attendees	All-staff view of dept calendars
Make changes to events	Add, edit or delete events	Dept teams managing their own calendar
Make changes and manage sharing	Full control including sharing settings	Calendar owner and Paul / Nehemia

5. Creating and Managing Events

5.1 Creating a New Event

#	Action	Details
1	Click a time slot	In your calendar view, click on the date and time you want. A quick-add box will appear.
2	Click 'More options'	To add full details, click 'More options' to open the detailed event editor.
3	Add a clear title	Use a descriptive title that includes the dept or campus where relevant. E.g. 'SLA Finance — Fee Deadline: Ilboru Campus'.
4	Set date and time	Set the correct start and end time. For all-day events (e.g. term start), tick 'All day'.
5	Choose the calendar	In the calendar dropdown, select the correct SLA calendar (not your personal calendar).
6	Add location or Google Meet	Add a room, campus or click 'Add Google Meet video conferencing' for remote sessions.
7	Add guests	Enter email addresses of anyone who needs an invitation. They will receive a notification.
8	Add a description	Include any preparation notes, links to agendas, documents or key information.
9	Set reminders	Add email or notification reminders (e.g. 1 day and 1 hour before for important events).
10	Click Save	Click Save. If you added guests, click 'Send' to notify them.

5.2 Recurring Events

For weekly meetings, monthly check-ins or recurring deadlines, use the repeat feature to avoid creating events manually each time.

10. When creating an event, click 'Does not repeat' and select your frequency (daily, weekly, monthly, custom).
11. For custom schedules (e.g. every second Monday), select 'Custom' and configure accordingly.
12. To edit a recurring event, click the event and choose whether to edit 'This event', 'This and following events' or 'All events' in the series.

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Set recurring events for: weekly momentum sessions, monthly SLT meetings, fee payment reminders, and term-start prep sessions. This saves significant admin time across the year.

5.3 Event Colour Coding

Use Google Calendar's colour feature to make your calendar easier to scan at a glance. The recommended SLA colour scheme is:

- **Blueberry (dark blue) — SLA-wide and leadership events**
- Banana (gold/yellow) — Finance and fee-related deadlines
- Sage (green) — Academic events and exam schedules
- Flamingo (pink) — HR events and staff wellbeing
- Tangerine (orange) — Operations and logistics
- Peacock (teal) — Marketing and admissions events
- Graphite (grey) — Personal reminders and internal prep

To change an event's colour: click the event, click the coloured dot next to the calendar name, and choose a colour.

6. Google Calendar on Mobile

The Google Calendar app is available on Android and iOS. All staff are encouraged to install it and enable notifications for SLA calendars.

13. Download the Google Calendar app from the Play Store or App Store.
14. Sign in with your Silverleaf Google Workspace account (@silverleafacademy.com).
15. Tap the menu (three lines) and scroll down to 'Other calendars'.
16. Make sure all SLA shared calendars are ticked to appear in your mobile view.
17. Go to Settings > Notifications and enable push notifications for important calendars.

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Enable 'Email notifications' for high-priority calendars (SLA — School Wide, your own department calendar) so you never miss a key deadline even when offline.

7. Integrations with SLA Systems

Google Calendar integrates with several tools used across the SLA network:

Google Workspace Integration

Google Meet — Every calendar event can include a Google Meet link for remote or hybrid sessions. Click 'Add Google Meet video conferencing' when creating any event.

Google Drive — Attach agendas, documents and resources directly to calendar events so attendees have everything they need in one place.

Gmail — Calendar events create automatic email confirmations. Guests receive invites, reminders and updates directly in their Gmail inbox.

Fellow AI — SLA's meeting tool (Fellow) syncs with Google Calendar to pull in scheduled meetings, generate agendas and capture action items automatically.

EdAdmin Integration

EdAdmin's Calendar & Events module can sync with Google Calendar. Once configured, events published in EdAdmin (parent-teacher meetings, school events, activity schedules) can appear in the SLA Google Calendar view.

To enable this: In EdAdmin, go to Calendar & Events > Settings > Google Calendar Integration and connect your Google Workspace account. Contact Paul or Nehemia for setup support.

8. Calendar Best Practices for SLA

Following these practices keeps calendars clean, useful and trusted across the whole team.

- **Always add events to the correct SLA calendar — not your personal calendar — so the right people can see them.**
- Use clear, specific event titles. Avoid vague titles like 'Meeting' — use 'SLA Finance — Monthly Review with KP' instead.
- Set reminders on all important events. Use 1-day and 1-hour reminders for deadlines, and 15-minute reminders for regular meetings.
- Include a description on every event with the agenda, preparation needed and any relevant links.
- Decline or remove events you are no longer attending so organisers have accurate RSVP counts.
- Do not delete shared events without first notifying all attendees.
- Review your calendar every Monday morning to confirm the week's priorities are correctly scheduled.
- Use the 'Find a time' feature when scheduling meetings with multiple attendees to avoid conflicts automatically.

9. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Calendar Responsibility
Paul (Data & Tech)	Owns SLA — School Wide and SLA — Data & Tech calendars. Manages Google Workspace calendar settings for the whole organisation.
Nehemia (Tech Support)	Supports staff with calendar setup, sharing and troubleshooting. Maintains Google Groups for bulk sharing.
Department Leaders	Own and manage their department calendar. Responsible for keeping it accurate and up to date.
All Staff	Subscribe to relevant SLA calendars. Keep personal calendar updated. Respond to event invitations promptly.
KP (CEO)	Reviews the SLA — School Wide calendar weekly. Confirms SLT meeting schedule monthly.

10. Troubleshooting

I cannot see a shared calendar

- Check that you have accepted the sharing invitation (look for an email from Google Calendar).
- In Google Calendar, click '+' next to 'Other calendars' and select 'Subscribe to calendar'.
- Ask the calendar owner to re-send the sharing invitation.

My event is showing on the wrong calendar

- Open the event, click Edit, and change the calendar dropdown to the correct SLA calendar.
- Click Save. The event will move to the correct calendar immediately.

I am not receiving reminders

- Go to Google Calendar Settings > Notifications and check that notifications are enabled for that calendar.
- Check your phone notification settings and ensure the Google Calendar app has permission to send notifications.

I need help with a calendar setup issue

- Contact Nehemia (Tech Support Officer) via Slack (#tech-support channel) or email nehemia@silverleafacademy.com.

Need Help?

For any Google Calendar questions or technical support, contact:

Paul — Data & Tech Manager: paul@silverleafacademy.com

Nehemia — Tech Support Officer: nehemia@silverleafacademy.com

Slack: #tech-support channel

This document is reviewed and updated each term. Last updated: June 2026.